

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Pharmaceutical English

Conversation lab

12 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For clinical development, regulatory affairs, pharmacovigilance, quality, CMC, manufacturing, medical affairs, market access, and compliance teams.

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 TPP Debate: Scientifically Interesting vs Clinically Meaningful

02 IND Readiness: CMC Is Not Just a Detail

03 Endpoint Debate: Convenient vs Clinically Relevant

04 Enrollment Rescue: Protocol Burden and Site Reality

05 Safety Signal: Possible Liver Risk

06 Data Readout: Statistically Significant but Modest Effect

07 Quality Deviation: Batch Release Pressure

08 Promotional Claim Review: Subgroup Data

09 MSL Boundary: Unsolicited Off-Label Question

10 Payer Evidence: Value Story Is Not the Same as Label

11 Biosimilar Discussion: Similar Is Not Identical

12 Launch Readiness: Approval Is Not Enough

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

TPP Debate: Scientifically Interesting vs Clinically Meaningful

A discovery team wants to advance a compound, but the development team is uncertain about the patient and evidence logic.

Roles: Discovery lead / Clinical development / Development program specialist

Discovery lead: The biomarker response is strong. We should move quickly.

Clinical development: The biology is promising, but the clinical target is not clear yet.

Development program specialist: Before we commit to the next study, we need a sharper TPP: target population, expected clinical benefit, dose rationale, safety assumptions, comparator, endpoint, and differentiation from standard of care.

Discovery lead: The mechanism is novel.

Development program specialist: Novel mechanism helps, but it does not replace evidence that patients, regulators, physicians, and payers will consider meaningful.

Discovery lead: I will revise the target product profile around the development question.

Development program specialist: Keep the evidence gaps visible so the next study has a clear purpose.

Notice the professional language

TPP - Target product profile describing desired product attributes and evidence needs.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

IND Readiness: CMC Is Not Just a Detail

A team wants to file an IND quickly, but CMC documentation is incomplete.

Roles: Program lead / CMC lead / Development program specialist

Program lead: Clinical is ready. Let's file the IND next month.

CMC lead: The stability package and analytical validation are not complete.

Development program specialist: An IND is not only a protocol. We need enough nonclinical, clinical, and CMC information to support safe human dosing and product quality. If CMC is incomplete, the clinical timeline may not be credible.

Program lead: Can we explain that the data are coming?

Development program specialist: We can propose a plan, but we should not present future work as current readiness. Let's identify the minimum data needed and the regulatory risk of filing early.

Program lead: I will reconcile the CMC milestones with the submission plan.

Development program specialist: Then regulatory can assess readiness using the actual available package.

Notice the professional language

IND - Investigational new drug application allowing clinical investigation in humans in the United States.

CMC - Chemistry, manufacturing, and controls information supporting product quality.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Endpoint Debate: Convenient vs Clinically Relevant

The team is choosing a primary endpoint for a Phase 2 trial.

Roles: Clinical operations / Medical lead / Development program specialist / Statistician

Clinical operations: The biomarker endpoint is easier to measure and faster.

Medical lead: But it may not persuade physicians.

Development program specialist: We should separate operational convenience from clinical relevance. If the biomarker is the primary endpoint, we need a strong rationale that it predicts patient benefit or supports the development decision.

Statistician: The study is not powered for the clinical endpoint.

Development program specialist: Then we should be explicit: the study may be decision-enabling for dose and signal, but not definitive for clinical benefit.

Clinical operations: I will document what this study can and cannot establish.

Development program specialist: Use that distinction consistently in the protocol rationale and readout.

Notice the professional language

Primary endpoint - Main outcome measure used to evaluate the primary objective.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Enrollment Rescue: Protocol Burden and Site Reality

Enrollment is behind plan and the team is considering more sites.

Roles: Clinical operations / Site manager / Development program specialist / Program lead

Clinical operations: We are 40 percent behind enrollment. We should activate more sites.

Site manager: The current sites say the visit schedule is too burdensome.

Development program specialist: More sites may help, but only if the protocol is feasible. We should examine screen failure reasons, visit burden, competing trials, eligibility criteria, and patient travel before adding cost.

Program lead: We need speed.

Development program specialist: Agreed, but speed without feasibility will only create more underperforming sites. Let's propose a rescue plan with root cause, amendment options, and site-support actions.

Clinical operations: I will compile the screen-failure reasons and site feedback.

Development program specialist: Any proposed protocol change must follow the required review and approval process.

Notice the professional language

Enrollment rescue should start with root cause, not only site count.

Protocol burden language helps connect operations to data quality.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Safety Signal: Possible Liver Risk

Several liver enzyme elevations have appeared across studies.

Roles: Safety physician / Clinical lead / Development program specialist / Regulatory affairs

Safety physician: We have a cluster of ALT elevations.

Clinical lead: Are they related to the drug?

Development program specialist: We should not jump to causality, but we also should not minimize it. Let's review timing, dose relationship, dechallenge, rechallenge, baseline risk factors, concomitant medications, seriousness, and whether the pattern changes the risk-benefit assessment.

Regulatory affairs: Do we need to notify FDA?

Development program specialist: Let's assess seriousness, expectedness, reasonable possibility, and reporting timelines against the protocol, regulations, and safety SOPs.

Safety physician: I will route the case information promptly through pharmacovigilance.

Development program specialist: Record the evidence and follow-up without implying causality has already been established.

Notice the professional language

Safety language should be calm, structured, and urgent where needed.

Avoid both premature causality and premature reassurance.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Data Readout: Statistically Significant but Modest Effect

A Phase 3 trial met the primary endpoint, but the effect size is small and safety events increased.

Roles: Executive / Biostatistician / Development program specialist / Commercial

Executive: The primary endpoint met the prespecified statistical criterion. Can we call this a major breakthrough?

Biostatistician: The effect is statistically significant, but the confidence interval is narrow around a modest benefit.

Development program specialist: We can say the primary endpoint was met, but we should not overstate clinical impact. The communication needs effect size, clinical relevance, safety profile, population, and comparison to current options.

Commercial: But we need a strong launch message.

Development program specialist: A strong message must still be supportable. Overclaiming now may create regulatory, credibility, and MLR risk later.

Executive: I will revise the claim to reflect the effect size and uncertainty.

Development program specialist: Submit the complete context for the required medical, legal, and regulatory review.

Notice the professional language

Confidence interval - An interval produced by a method with a stated long-run coverage rate under its assumptions.

Primary endpoint - Main outcome measure used to evaluate the primary objective.

MLR - Medical, legal, and regulatory review of materials.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Quality Deviation: Batch Release Pressure

A batch is needed for launch supply, but an OOS result is under investigation.

Roles: Supply lead / Quality / Development program specialist

Supply lead: If we do not release this batch, launch inventory is at risk.

Quality: The OOS investigation is not closed.

Development program specialist: The open investigation needs the required quality assessment and authorized disposition. We should not promise release while that process remains unresolved; supply planning needs an accurate statement of the current status.

Supply lead: Can we release with a memo?

Development program specialist: A memo is not a substitute for the applicable quality process. The authorized quality team must assess the evidence and determine the appropriate disposition under the current requirements.

Supply lead: I will communicate the pending batch status to supply planning.

Development program specialist: Quality will provide the authorized disposition through the controlled process.

Notice the professional language

OOS - Out of specification result requiring investigation.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Promotional Claim Review: Subgroup Data

Marketing wants to use a subgroup result in launch materials.

Roles: Marketing / Medical reviewer / Development program specialist

Marketing: The subgroup response looks impressive. Can we make it the headline?

Medical reviewer: It was exploratory and not powered.

Development program specialist: The subgroup may be scientifically interesting, but as a promotional headline it could be misleading. We need to check whether the claim is consistent with approved labeling, adequately supported, and presented with appropriate context and risk information.

Marketing: Can we say 'especially effective' in that subgroup?

Development program specialist: Not unless that claim is supported and approved. We can discuss a balanced, label-consistent statement or keep the subgroup in scientific exchange if appropriate.

Marketing: I will remove the unsupported headline from the draft.

Development program specialist: Keep the exploratory analysis clearly identified in any material submitted for review.

Notice the professional language

Scientific exchange - Non-promotional scientific communication, usually handled within medical affairs boundaries.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 09 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

MSL Boundary: Unsolicited Off-Label Question

A physician asks an MSL about an off-label use during a scientific exchange.

Roles: Physician / MSL / Development program specialist

Physician: Have you seen data for use in younger patients?

MSL: That is outside the approved indication.

Development program specialist: I can route your unsolicited scientific question through our approved medical-information process. We need to distinguish the current approved indication from any other use and provide an appropriately reviewed, balanced response.

Physician: So you have data?

Development program specialist: I will confirm what information is available and arrange a response through that process, including study design, limitations, and the relevant context. I cannot promise a particular conclusion before reviewing the evidence.

Physician: I will record the question and preferred response channel.

Development program specialist: The designated medical-information team can then provide the appropriately reviewed response.

Notice the professional language

Boundary language should be clear without shutting down legitimate scientific exchange.

Balance and context matter in medical affairs conversations.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 10 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Payer Evidence: Value Story Is Not the Same as Label

Market access is preparing for payer discussions after approval.

Roles: Market access / HEOR / Development program specialist / Commercial

Market access: Payers will ask why this deserves preferred formulary status.

HEOR: We have clinical data but limited real-world outcomes.

Development program specialist: The payer value story should connect eligible population, clinical benefit, safety, budget impact, comparator, adherence, and unmet need. We should not imply outcomes we have not measured.

Commercial: Can we say it reduces hospitalizations?

Development program specialist: Only if the evidence supports that claim for the relevant population and context. Otherwise, we can frame it as a hypothesis or evidence-generation need.

Market access: I will separate measured outcomes from modeled assumptions.

Development program specialist: That makes the evidence-generation needs clear without implying unobserved benefits.

Notice the professional language

Market access language must separate approved label, evidence, and economic hypothesis.

Payer communication should avoid unsupported outcomes claims.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 11 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Biosimilar Discussion: Similar Is Not Identical

A cross-functional team is preparing educational material on a biosimilar.

Roles: Commercial / Regulatory affairs / Development program specialist / Medical affairs

Commercial: Can we say it is the same as the reference product?

Regulatory affairs: Biosimilar language is more specific than that.

Development program specialist: We should say highly similar with no clinically meaningful differences in safety, purity, and potency, consistent with the approved biosimilar framework. 'Same' may oversimplify and create confusion.

Medical affairs: What about interchangeability?

Development program specialist: Interchangeability has a specific regulatory meaning. We should use it only if the product has that designation and the material explains it accurately.

Commercial: I will verify the current product status and jurisdiction-specific terminology.

Development program specialist: Use the reviewed wording consistently in the final material.

Notice the professional language

Biosimilar language needs regulatory precision.

Avoid simplifying technical terms into misleading equivalence.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 12 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Launch Readiness: Approval Is Not Enough

The team is two months from expected approval and launch readiness is uneven.

Roles: General manager / Launch lead / Development program specialist

General manager: If approval comes on time, we launch immediately.

Launch lead: Supply, MLR materials, medical training, payer coverage, and PV intake process still have open risks.

Development program specialist: Approval is necessary but not sufficient for launch. We need a readiness view across label, supply, quality release, safety reporting, medical information, field training, access, and promotional materials.

General manager: What is the critical path?

Development program specialist: Supply release, final label-dependent MLR approval, safety intake readiness, and payer communication are the main dependencies. I recommend a weekly risk review until launch decision.

General manager: I will assign owners to the open readiness items.

Development program specialist: Bring the evidence of completion to the launch review before requesting a decision.

Notice the professional language

Medical information - Function that responds to medical inquiries with approved, balanced, evidence-based information.

MLR - Medical, legal, and regulatory review of materials.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Drug Development Strategy, Unmet Need, TPP, and Evidence Logic

SHARED CASE

A development slide describes an early laboratory result as evidence that a product will benefit patients. Clinical benefit has not been established.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The result supports further investigation in this laboratory setting. It does not establish patient benefit. I'll revise the wording to distinguish the early finding from the clinical questions still to be tested.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Regulatory Pathways, IND Readiness, NDA/BLA Strategy, and Agency Interaction

SHARED CASE

A team is preparing a question for a regulatory meeting. The draft asks broadly whether the whole development plan is acceptable.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could we identify the specific issue, proposed approach, and evidence supporting it? A focused question will make the requested feedback clearer than asking for general approval of the plan.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Clinical Trial Design, Protocols, GCP, and Operations

SHARED CASE

Two trial documents give different visit-window descriptions. A coordinator is asked which one to use but has not confirmed the controlling version.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

The documents appear inconsistent. Which approved version governs this activity? I'll raise the discrepancy through the study process and request clarification before communicating a definitive instruction.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Endpoints, Estimands, Statistics, Data Readouts, and Clinical Meaning

SHARED CASE

A trial slide highlights a secondary endpoint while the primary endpoint result needs explanation. The audience may mistake the highlighted result for the main study conclusion.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

Let's state the primary endpoint result clearly and identify the secondary analysis as such. The presentation should explain what each result supports and any limits on interpretation.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Pharmacovigilance, Safety Signals, Risk-Benefit, and Label Updates

SHARED CASE

A team member receives a report of a possible adverse event. Key details are incomplete, and the team has a defined safety-reporting process.

Role A | Responding professional

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Useful expressions

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Cover this until after your first attempt

I've received a report that needs review through the safety process. Here are the details available and the information still missing. Please confirm receipt; I have not determined causality or classification.

Second round

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

CMC, CGMP, Quality Events, Manufacturing, and Supply

SHARED CASE

A quality review identifies missing documentation in a batch record. A manager asks whether the batch can be described as fully reviewed.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

The documentation review is still open. I'll report the missing items and their review status. We should not describe the batch review as complete until the responsible quality team confirms it.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Labeling, Medical Affairs, Promotion Review, and Compliance Boundaries

SHARED CASE

A draft promotional slide uses stronger benefit language than the approved material supplied for review.

Role A | Responding professional

State a concern respectfully and propose a practical route forward. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You want to move quickly and initially overlook a relevant condition. Ask why it matters, then consider a practical route forward that respects the real constraint.

Useful expressions

I understand the goal. My concern is

That statement goes beyond

Could we ... before confirming ...?

Cover this until after your first attempt

The proposed wording goes beyond the material we have been asked to use. Could we revise it to match the approved claim and send the change through the appropriate review process?

Second round

The other person repeats the request more firmly. Restate the specific concern calmly and explain the appropriate next route.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Market Access, RWE, Launch Readiness, Biosimilars, and Lifecycle Management

SHARED CASE

A market-access presentation combines trial findings and observational data without identifying the different study designs.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Let's label the evidence sources separately. The trial and observational study answer different questions and have different limitations. That distinction will help the audience interpret the findings accurately.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-06. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Pharmaceutical English

Professional audience: clinical development, regulatory affairs, pharmacovigilance, quality, CMC, manufacturing, medical affairs, market access, and compliance teams

Scope: Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Dialogue 01: TPP Debate: Scientifically Interesting vs Clinically Meaningful

Original fictional setting: A discovery team wants to advance a compound, but the development team is uncertain about the patient and evidence logic.

Professional roles: Discovery lead / Clinical development / Development program specialist

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Discovery lead: The biomarker response is strong. We should move quickly.

Clinical development: The biology is promising, but the clinical target is not clear yet.

Development program specialist: Before we commit to the next study, we need a sharper TPP: target population, expected clinical benefit, dose rationale, safety assumptions, comparator, endpoint, and differentiation from standard of care.

Discovery lead: The mechanism is novel.

Development program specialist: Novel mechanism helps, but it does not replace evidence that patients, regulators, physicians, and payers will consider meaningful.

Discovery lead: I will revise the target product profile around the development question.

Development program specialist: Keep the evidence gaps visible so the next study has a clear purpose.

Vocabulary in this exchange: TPP: Target product profile describing desired product attributes and evidence needs.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

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Create more scenario dialogues

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Vocabulary in this exchange: TPP: Target product profile describing desired product attributes and evidence needs.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

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